Murugan said Sivarasan was now ready to conduct the dry runs ordered by his boss Pottu Amman. The first was conducted on 18 April on the crowded Marina beach in Madras, a location frequently used for holding political rallies. Reportedly, Nalini added here, Sivarasan had information suggesting that Marina beach was the venue for Rajiv Gandhi's rally in Tamil Nadu. The same meeting, according to some newspaper reports, was to be jointly addressed with the Congress party's ally, AIADMK supremo J. Jayalalithaa. The assassins thought the Marina beach venue would be reused when Rajiv visited Tamil Nadu next. This dry run was photographed by Ravi Shankar.[9]

Ravi Shankar was brought in before Nalini. He confessed he had photographed the meeting and was paid by Subha Sundaram's agency. The agency also took a video recording but he did not know who shot it. Kaarthikeyan asked his team to launch a hunt for the video recordings of the dry runs. Murugan further revealed that they did not get too close to the two leaders on that dry run. Haribabu was also present but was not asked to photographically record it. Ravi Shankar said it was Haribabu who told him later that the target was going to be a politician. For the first time, Ravi Shankar said he was scared by the thought of what they were getting into. But Haribabu was unruffled about it, he claimed.

Verma next brought in the drawing experts and got sketches of the dry run made while Murugan spoke about the event again. He claimed that the next dry run was carried out on 12 May at the political rally of V.P. Singh and DMK supremo M. Karunanidhi in Nandanam near Madras. The exercise was more advanced and closer to success this time as Dhanu was able to penetrate the security details around the former Prime Minister V.P. Singh and touch his feet. Exactly nine days later, Dhanu repeated the act with Rajiv Gandhi.

Once the meeting was over, Murugan pointed out to Nalini that she had missed photographing the event and that it had made Sivarasan angry. However, this time Haribabu recorded the session on video for Sundaram's photo agency, which would have sent it to Jaffna for scrutiny at the behest of Sivarasan.[10]